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THIS SUMMER IS becoming torrid for the aviation sector. In the US, low-cost carrier Spirit has shut operations after 34 years in service. The reason? Rising jet fuel prices triggered by the West Asia conflict. Alarm bells are ringing back home too. The Federation of Indian Airlines has written to the government about operations becoming unsustainable and the need for relief measures.

38 | A multitude of things seems to be going wrong for the sector. One is rising jet fuel prices. Domestic carriers have also been hit by the rising US dollar against the rupee. Closure of airspace over West Asia and Pakistan is forcing Indian carriers to take a longer route to go west. Adding fuel to the fire is Prime Minister Narendra Modi's appeal to citizens to reduce international travel.

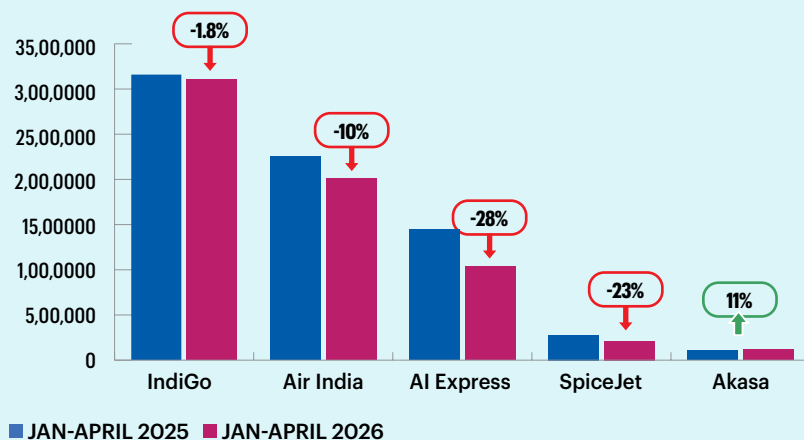
And the country is echoing this sentiment. Chairman of RPG Enterprises, Harsh Goenka, took to microblogging website X to announce strict optimisation of travel. "Foreign travel is to be curtailed to the absolute minimum," his post read.

The Delhi government has taken a similar step. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has announced that no minister or



GAUGING THE IMPACT

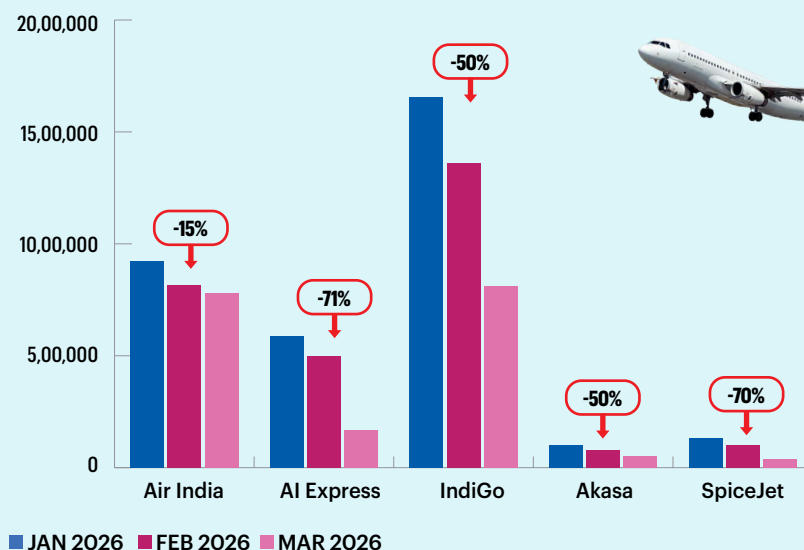
- Seat capacity of Air India Express and SpiceJet has been hit the most
- Akasa saw growth as it started deploying major capacity only in FY26



NOTE % FIGURES SHOW CHANGE FROM JAN TO MAR **SOURCE** OAG

INTERNATIONAL AIR TRAFFIC (PRE VS POST CRISIS)

- Air India Express and SpiceJet are the worst hit
- IndiGo, Akasa saw a 50% cut in passengers flown



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